

BASIC SIGHT-SINGING AND EAR TRAINING FOR CHURCH SINGERS

RHYTHM EXERCISES 5.1



IDENTIFYING RHYTHMIC GROUPINGS IN LITURGICAL TEXTS

Instructions

1. For each of the liturgical texts below, print out the slide
2. Underline the stressed syllables of the text and note if they fall into duple or triple rhythmic groupings by counting ONE-two, or ONE-two-three.
3. Identify the triple groupings with a horizontal bracket
4. Take a picture with your phone and email it to OCATeacher1@oca.org

SAMPLE:

When the stone had been sealed by the Jews,
while the soldiers were guarding Your most pure body,
You arose on the third day, O Savior, granting life to the world.

EXAMPLE 1

ST. SYMEON'S PRAYER

Lord, now lettest Thou Thy servant depart in peace,
according to Thy word,
for mine eyes have seen Thy salvation,
which Thou hast prepared before the face of all people,
a light to enlighten the Gentiles,
and to be the glory of Thy people Israel.

EXAMPLE 2

TROPARION OF THE HOLY CROSS

O Lord, save Your people and bless Your inheritance.
Grant victories to the Orthodox Christians over their adversaries,
and by virtue of Your Cross preserve Your habitation.

EXAMPLE 3

TROPARION OF THE TRANSFIGURATION

You were transfigured on the mountain, O Christ God,
revealing Your glory to Your disciples as far as they could bear it.
Let Your everlasting Light also shine upon us sinners,
through the prayers of the Theotokos.
O Giver of Light, glory to You!

EXAMPLE 4

HEIRMOS TO THE THEOTOKOS

More hon'able than the Cherubim
and more glorious beyond compare than the Seraphim,
without corruption you gave birth to God the Word,
true Theotokos, we magnify you.

EXAMPLE 5

HEIRMOS TO THE THEOTOKOS

I will open my mouth and it will be filled with the spirit,
and I will utter a word for the Queen and Mother,
and I will be seen keeping radiant festival,
and rejoicing I will sing her wonders.

Please proceed to
UNIT 5.2 – PITCH

